



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

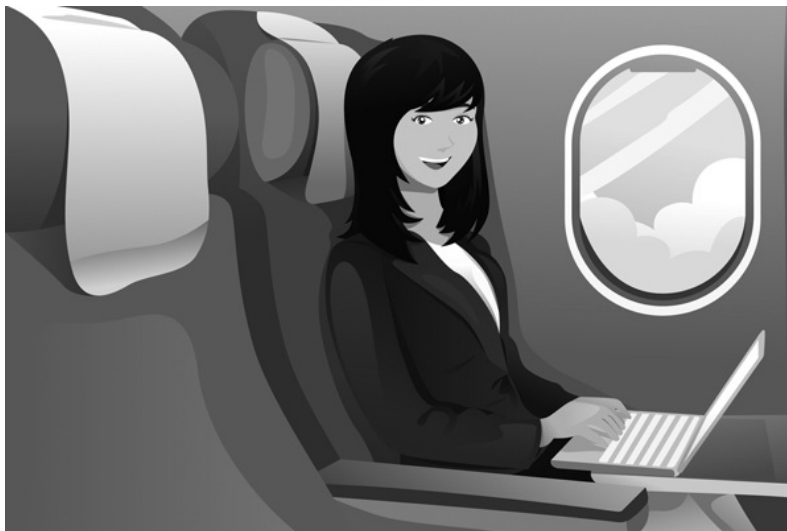
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Let's Start!

Boris sends an e-mail from Chicago.



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- When you are traveling, how do you communicate with friends and family?
- Do you prefer to receive an e-mail or a handwritten letter? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk or report about things, actions, events, or people related to work and job issues.
- I can claim, mention, request, or point out an idea, thing, or issue in the workplace.
- I can exchange complex information and advice on the full range of matters related to the occupational role.





Let's Explore!

Boris **checks in***

* To "check in" can mean to register at reception or to send someone an update.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Hello Denise,

Sorry I haven't written to you sooner, but it's been a bit hectic around here. The flight was relatively uneventful, and we made it to our hotel in decent time, but that's where the problems started. The hotel receptionist claimed that we didn't have a reservation, and when she finally found it, she claimed that we had only booked one room. When Adam mentioned that we had actually booked two rooms, and that we had made a few special orders, she requested that we provide a booking receipt. Fortunately we had one with us, and we were able to clear everything up. Then, at the conference, we ran into an acquaintance and ... well, that's probably a story for another day. I don't want to bog you down with unnecessary details.

The conference has been very productive. On the first day, we had a large amount of foot traffic. Our kiosk was positively swarming with potential clients. By day two, Adam pointed out that we were already running out of promotional materials and business cards. We had a sign-up sheet printed up so that those interested in receiving more information could leave their e-mail address. I really think we have made some inroads in convincing a few Midwestern writers to move their business to Boston.

I know, I harp on Adam sometimes, but he really is a great people-person. He worked the booth relentlessly, and he walked more than a few inquisitive writers through the publishing process. I'm confident that a few worthwhile leads have been generated for BFP.

Thank you again for giving us the opportunity. You can expect a full report upon my return.

Best regards,
Boris





Let's Practice!

It's been a bit hectic around here!

Instructions: Use the options from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

booth / made some inroads / sign-up sheet / leads/ kiosk /
people-person / bog you down / swarming / foot traffic

I don't want to 1. _____ with unnecessary details. On the first day, we had a large amount of 2. _____. Our 3. _____ was positively 4. _____ with potential clients. We had a 5. _____ printed up so that those interested in receiving more information could leave their e-mail address. I really think we have 6. _____ in convincing a few Midwestern writers to move their business to Boston. He really is a great 7. _____. He worked the 8. _____ relentlessly. I'm confident that a few worthwhile 9. _____ have been generated for BFP.



Let's Practice!

What does Boris' email report?

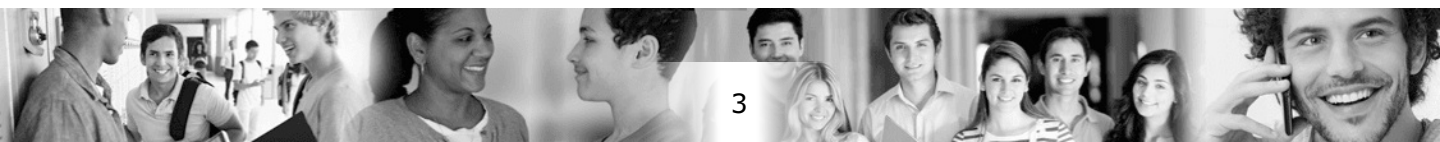
Instructions: Match and complete the sentences in Column A and B. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. The hotel receptionist
2. When she finally found the reservation, she
3. When Adam mentioned that
4. She requested that
5. Adam pointed out that

COLUMN B

- a. we were already running out of promotional material and business cards.
- b. _____ claimed that we only booked one room.
- c. we provide a booking receipt.
- d. we had actually booked two rooms.
- e. claimed that we didn't have a reservation.





Extension Activity

Send a written update.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On a piece of paper, write a list of ten activities you have done in the past three days.
- From your notes, compose a written update explaining your activities to a classmate.
- Include an appropriate greeting and closing.
- Read your update to a classmate.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I compose a written update.

☐ ☐

I include a "greeting" and a "goodbye".

☐ ☐

I share my update with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to bog down** (verb): to slow the progress of someone or something
e.g. I don't want to bog you down with unnecessary details.
- foot traffic** (noun): people who are moving from one place to another on foot; pedestrians
e.g. On the first day, we had a large amount of foot traffic.
- kiosk** (noun): a small stand where something is sold or handed out through an open window
e.g. Our kiosk was positively swarming with potential clients.
- to swarm** (verb): to move together in a large group
e.g. The eager customers swarmed the booth.
- booth** (noun): a table set up by an organization at a fair or conference to promote or sell products
e.g. He worked the booth relentlessly.
- sign-up sheet** (noun): a piece of paper on which people can request information or a particular product
e.g. We had a sign-up sheet printed up so that those interested in receiving more information could leave their e-mail address.
- to make inroads** (expression): to make progress
e.g. I really think we have made some inroads in convincing a few Midwestern writers to move their business to Boston.
- people-person** (noun): someone who is friendly and personable
e.g. He really is a great people-person.
- to walk through** (verb): to explain something
e.g. He walked more than a few inquisitive writers through the publishing process.
- lead** (noun): a potential sale or client
e.g. I'm confident that a few worthwhile leads have been generated for BFP.





Learning Points

Review of Tenses: Simple Present, Present Perfect, Simple Past and Past Perfect

There are many different uses and applications of these grammar points. It is important to be able to distinguish between these meanings and uses.

Refer to the chart for a summary and examples of the Simple Past, Past Perfect, Present Perfect and Simple Present tenses.

Tense	Meaning/Use	Example
Simple Present	to describe states to report what you have heard or read	<i>I really enjoy traveling.</i> <i>The article explains why business is so slow this year.</i>
Present Perfect	to talk about something in the past when you don't know when it happened to talk about how long something happened to talk about something that happened in a period of time up to the present	<i>I have complained about the job before.</i> <i>The business has grown a lot since we worked there.</i> <i>We have made many business connections this year.</i>
Simple Past	to indicate that something happened at a specific time in the past to talk about situations that existed before a period of time, but not now	<i>She arrived at the airport at 6 p.m.</i> <i>When I was a kid, I played soccer a lot.</i>
Past Perfect	to indicate that something occurred before another action in the past and to show that something happened before a specific time in the past	<i>I had played on the soccer team before I joined the basketball team.</i>

Examples:

- *Sorry I haven't written to you sooner, but it's been a bit hectic around here.*
- *The flight was relatively uneventful, and we made it to our hotel in decent time.*
- *Adam mentioned that we had made a few special orders.*





Learning Points

- *I don't want to bog you down with unnecessary details.*

Report Verbs: Quoting

You often report things that people have said or what they think. In writing, you can report their actual words in a quotation.

For example:

*"I suppose you've completed the report", she said.
He asked "What should I do now?"*

Always use quotation marks when reporting direct speech or texts.

In stories or novels, it is common to place the reporting verb (*say, reply, ask*) before the subject when the reporting clause comes after the quotation.

For example:

"When will they be back?" asked Joe. (or, Joe asked)

Examples:

- *The hotel receptionist claimed that we didn't have a reservation.*
- *When Adam mentioned that we had actually booked two rooms, she requested that we provide a booking receipt.*
- *Adam pointed out that we were already running out of promotional material and business cards.*
- *When she finally found it, she claimed that we had only booked one room.*

